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CAMBRIDGE ANALYTICA'S INFLUENCE ON YOUR VOTE

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MEMORIES AND DEMERY'S

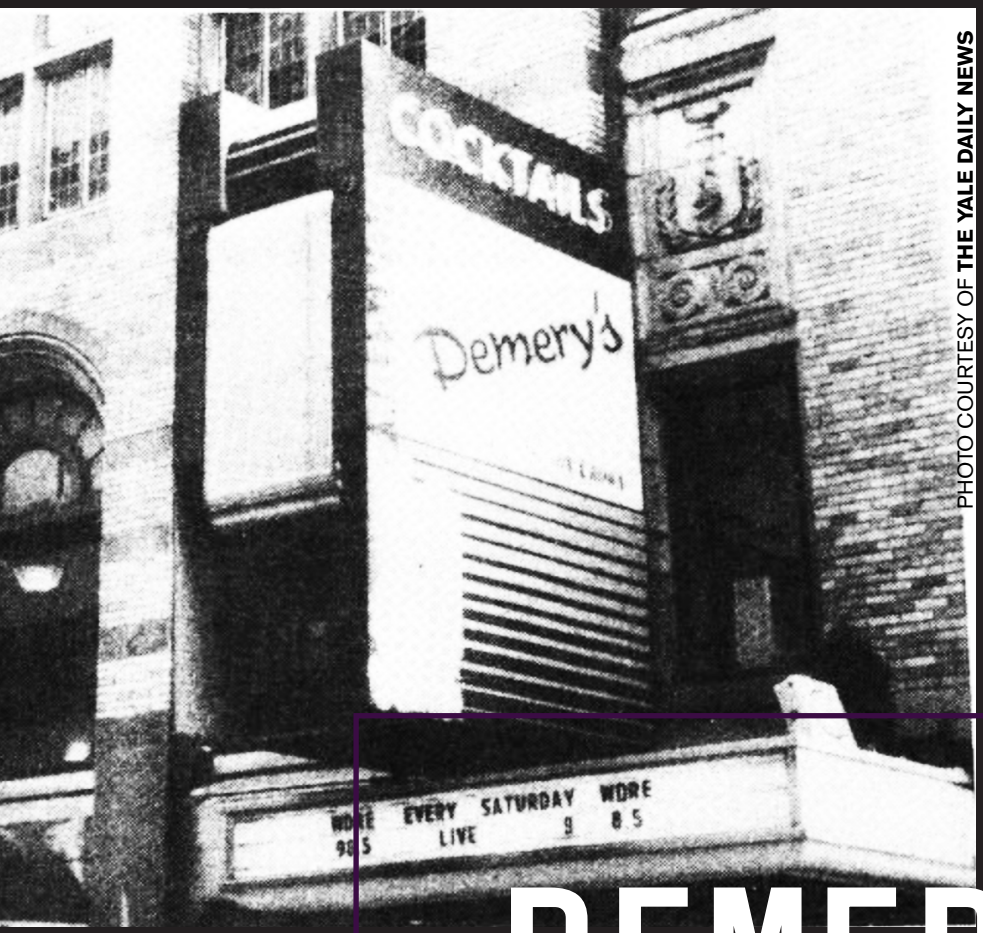


PHOTO COURTESY OF **THE YALE DAILY NEWS**

Yale's Heavy Hand Over One Broadway

BY **DANIEL YADIN**

BEFORE PATAGONIA began selling 12-dollar packs of bison jerky, before Au Bon Pain brought corporate coffee to New Haven, before Yale controlled the leases of most of the stores on Broadway, Demery's was making its thick pizza crust with too much cornmeal. A slice from Demery's was big and slightly sweet and tasted strongly of tomato, but the bottom of the pizza was littered with hard yellow bumps. Some Yalies compared it to gravel.

That didn't stop Yale students from eating the pizza, though. Demery's, a pizzeria by day and a club by night, stood at One Broadway, the current site of Patagonia, throughout the 1980s and the first half of the 1990s. It closed in 1994, when Yale purchased the property and installed an Au Bon Pain.

In the 1990s, Yale began a conscious effort to acquire the properties surrounding the university as part of its 7.5 million dollar Broadway beautification project. At the time, the businesses along Broadway were diverse in their function and ownership: the Yankee Doodle Diner sat at the intersection of Elm and York; Cutler's Record Store was a musical hub on Broadway; the Daily Caffe provided the Downtown neighborhood with a taste of coffee and bohemia. Positioned at the entrance of the district, framing the busy corner of Broadway and York, was Demery's.

Broadway did not shed its old character—dominated by local business, accessible to New Haven residents—on its own. Many Yale administrators in the 1990s, including then-President Richard Levin and Vice President for New Haven and State Affairs Bruce Alexander, mobilized to assert control over the district, buying commercial property on Broadway and inviting large national chains.

Yale's plan, Vice President Alexander stated at the time, was "to start to buy the properties on Broadway and start to treat that retail district with the dignity it deserves."

Demery's invited the type of behavior that university administrators might have found undesirable.

"It was great fun to go up the Branford/Saybrook tower and launch water balloons from a giant slingshot just after closing time at Dem's," recalled an alumnus.

In the same comment thread on an alumni page, another Yale graduate replied: "It's also worth mentioning that this was shut down after a balloon caught a woman in the face and detached her retina."

In New Haven today, over 85 businesses and 500 residences are on property owned by Yale University Properties (YUP), the branch of Yale's Office of New Haven and State Affairs created in 1996 to manage the university's expanding proprietary portfolio. Overall, the university controls more than 270,000 square feet of office and retail property in New Haven.

Many feel a distinct sense of place left Broadway with the local businesses.

Yale alumnus and professor Elihu Rubin told *The Politic* that the Broadway of today has "the feeling of an outdoor mall."

This was not always the case.

ON MOST NIGHTS, Demery's brought out the cheap beer at nine. All types of New Haven residents—locals, Southern Connecticut State University students, older Yalies and younger ones with good fake IDs—would stream into the club for a night of dancing and drinking. Multiple Yale alumni told *The Politic* that it was one of the only places they could recall where Yale students and New Haven locals organically interacted.

"It was a place for underage drinking, and one of the places where town and gown would come together," an alumnus said.

A Yale graduate told *The Politic* that "at times the Yalie-local connection wasn't one of mutual respect. That said, myself and another roommate are still married to lovely [non-Yale] women we met [at Demery's] in the late 80s."

At Demery's, most women wore their hair big and their jeans acid-washed ("Lotta hairspray," recalls a Yale alumna), and students in nearby colleges could hear motorcycles pulling up to the club on Saturdays. There were always almost as many people out on the corner of Broadway and York as there were inside the club. Across the street, an aged hippie named Wally would usually be selling flowers.

With floor-to-ceiling windows wrapping around the exterior of the building, "you could do a 'fly by' without going in...If no one you were interested in seeing was inside, you kept on walking," recalled an alumna.

And from suites in Trumbull College, Yale students could watch partiers dance on the tables until the windows steamed up.

A glass vestibule, separate from the dancing area, served takeout pizza and funnel cake throughout the night. Through the window of the takeout counter, cooks could be seen cutting, throwing, and spinning raw crusts, and many Morse students would walk down York Street in the late hours of the night, through the smell of stale beer and cigarettes, for last call pizza.

But Demery's was not purely mindless fun. Many Yale students stayed away from the club for fear of the regular "Friday Night Fights." Yalies of the era described teeth punched out on the dance floor, shards of glass in roommates' arms, and crutches smashed to bits against a heckler's body. There would often be an ambulance and police car waiting in anticipation across the street.

Seen by some as rowdy, violent, and dominated by Yale jocks and locals, Demery's was not a welcoming space for many LGBTQ+ Yale students.

It was "not a place for anyone who was out," an alumnus told *The Politic*. "I was in Morse, so I had to walk



by it every Friday and Saturday to get home. I knew to keep my head down, [not] make eye contact, move like water, flow around people."

The business's decline began as its general character—loud, frequently violent, rife with underage drinking—grew to conflict with Yale's vision of Broadway.

There was a sense among university administrators, including then-President Richard Levin, that the Broadway area was run-down, poorly managed, and in need of improvement that only Yale ownership could offer. According to Rubin, the university began thinking of Broadway's retail area as a potential single, unified shopping district that could be consolidated under Yale for the benefit of students and the broader community.

A harbinger of trouble came to Demery's in the fall of 1993, before the weekend of the Harvard-Yale football game. On November 18 of that year, New Haven and Yale police officers, along with Connecticut State Liquor Commission officials, raided Demery's as part of a crackdown on underage drinking. They slapped the bar with 14 violations.

It had always been an open secret that a fraudulent International Student Identification card from a local travel agency or AAA could gain one admission to Demery's. Allegedly, an underage student was once let in after using a department store credit card as ID.

But this raid came just a few months before the business's lease was up for renewal. Demery's was set on edge.

"It seems like they're after us," an anonymous employee told the *Yale Daily News* at the time. "I don't know if we'll be here after the lease expires in '94."

Betty Trachtenberg, the former Dean of Student Affairs who once instilled order on a cappella rush night by patrolling Old Campus with a Super Squirter water gun, offered a tepid denial of Yale's involvement in the crackdown at the time: "If Yale is behind this, I'm not. I think it is unlikely."

The defiant manager of Demery's, John Pickard, expressed no fear about the upcoming lease expiration: "As long as we want to be here, we'll be here."

Pickard was wrong. Demery's would not survive its lease renegotiation. Within the year, Au Bon Pain would be setting up shop in the property, and Yale would be announcing its 1.3 million dollar acquisition of One Broadway.

Alumni remembered rumors of foul play, possibly in the form of an anti-Demery's campaign led by the famously stringent Dean Trachtenberg. No one fanned the flames of conspiracy harder than owner Jerry Demery did.

Demery accused Yale of orchestrating the rent increase that forced him to move his restaurant to a farther-removed Crown Street location.

His business was "the fall guy for the Yale administration and the police department," Demery told the *Yale Daily News* after Yale's September 1994 purchase of One Broadway. "Anything in our area, they tagged our name on it. I was singled out because of the location on the corner, the attraction to outside students and customers, and the goal to eliminate alcohol from campus."

At the time, Yale administrators shed no public tears about the loss of Demery's.

Referring to One Broadway, then-University Secretary Linda Lorimer stated that "the University has long looked to that location as an area which would be important for the development of a longer-term strategy of having an attractive establishment for Yale students and New Haven residents."

"We are not unconscious of the security issues around that site in recent years," she added.

Understandably, the safety of Yale students was a primary concern of Yale administrators. Just three years prior, in 1991, Christian Prince, a sophomore in Pierson, was murdered in a nighttime mugging on Hillhouse Avenue. The killing shook Yale, and contributed to to the 1992 resignation of President Benno Schmidt.

Because Yale suffered from New Haven's reputation as a violent, unsafe city, it did not benefit from businesses like Demery's.

"Demery's was a pizza and beer joint," Rubin told *The Politic*. "Along with Toad's Place, there was a sense among Yale administrators and planners from the Office of New Haven and State Affairs that Demery's... created too much uncertainty, too much risk at that corner."

Au Bon Pain stood in opposition to this. At the time, the Boston-based chain had a strong Harvard connection, and its entry to Broadway was a sign for many that Yale wanted to mimic for New Haven what Harvard had done for Harvard Square: create a benign, appealing, and nonthreatening area for students.

The reaction to the switch was mixed.

"ABP started the Cambridgization of New Haven that took all the personality away and left nothing but retail hell," alumna Tracey Lynn Lloyd BF '95 told *The Politic*.

Even so, others appreciated the area's material improvement. The neighborhood had been "a dump" before Yale's involvement, George



PHOTO BY **ALICE OH**

Koutroumanis, co-owner of Yorkside Pizza, told *The New York Times* in 1999, well into President Levin's consolidation of control over Broadway. By that point, Yale had already acquired at least 19 New Haven properties, spending over 20 million dollars in under six years.

During the 90s, neighborhood mainstays like Cutler's Record Shop, Quality Wine Shop, and the Daily Caffe were moved off Broadway or outright closed. A series of buildings were torn down and built anew to house J. Crew and Urban Outfitters. And the area was branded the Shops at Yale, as clear a display of ownership as they come.

At some point between then and now, Demery's, exiled to Crown Street, quietly shut its doors. Its closure was not noted in the press.

After Au Bon Pain closed in 2013, One Broadway hosted a series of temporary tenants—the DNA Emporium, Peabody II—before Patagonia moved in.

TODAY, PATAGONIA brings a different character to One Broadway. Inside, a wall collage highlights the corporation's humanitarian mission ("CAUSE NO UNNECESSARY HARM"). Prominently displayed are the Patagonia-branded books *The Responsible Company*, *Tools for Grassroots Activists*, and *Let My People Go Surfing: The Education of a Reluctant Businessman*, whose chapters are entitled "History," "Philosophy," "Turn Around and Take a Step Forward," and "Thank You."

A corner of the store marked "Patagonia Provisions" brands its packs of dehydrated food as part of Patagonia's investment in "regenerative agriculture." Purchasing one Thermos will "give one person in need clean water for a year." It costs 36 dollars.

Windows still wrap around the exterior of One Broadway. Students lazily jaywalk towards Saybrook and a woman sells flowers farther up York. Gray light filters into the store.

Patagonia has entered a city where few residents could hope to afford the Better Sweater Jacket, let alone its 79 dollar miniature child's counterpart. New Haven's poverty rate of 36 percent is nearly three times as high as that of Connecticut as a whole, and the city's per capita income is 16,393 dollars, or approximately 33 Recycled Wool Jackets.

For some, Demery's was neither functional nor desirable. Patagonia is a better fit for YUP's vision of large, national chains drawing shoppers to the Shops at Yale. It is the ideal New Haven institution, at least to the Yale administration.

It's tempting to feel the tug towards a romantic past, reconstructed through hazy, nostalgic recollection, and to wish today's Yale students had a Demery's of their own.

Nostalgia is a powerful emotion. When *The Politic* posted on the Yale alumni Facebook page for comments on Demery's, hundreds of responses poured out in a few hours. Today's Yale students probably won't reminisce as passionately about Patagonia in thirty years.

But "a key theme for people who study cities and how they change," cautioned Rubin, "is to accept the fact that every generation will form its own new connections to the city."

Students form their own meaningful sense of place at Yale and in New Haven, and commercial establishments play just one role in forming this community.

Despite the lamentation of the passing of familiar places, "we can't assume, or even anticipate, on [new people's] behalf what will be popular or meaningful," Rubin said. "Yale students of today...will remember what they remember. They may be forming their own bonds to these places, and they may look fondly back on late nights at the Junzi Kitchen."

"God bless that."

LOVE LETTERS

AUSTRALIA'S POSTAL SURVEY ON GAY MARRIAGE IGNITES STUDENT ACTIVISM

BY **CJ IRSFELD**

AS SHE WALKED DOWN a Canberra street on a sunny October day, Robyn Lewis was ecstatic. Rainbow flags hung from houses; "Vote Yes" signs adorned lawns and shop windows.

"I'm 21," Lewis, an Australian National University (ANU) student, told *The Politic*. "And I have not seen this level of community engagement with a campaign before."

For the first time, Australia may join English-speaking allies in Canada, the UK, and the U.S. in recognizing same-sex marriage. The fate of one of the nation's most significant LGBTI rights initiatives will be decided this month (LGBTI is the term widely used in Australia). The question rests largely in the hands of the citizens—and young people have something to say about it.

By November 7, every registered voter in Australia will have received a survey in the mail from the government, asking: "Should the law be changed to allow same-sex couples to marry?"

This massive poll takes the form of a non-binding, non-compulsory plebiscite: a direct vote on changing federal law intended to serve as a gauge of public opinion for

lawmakers. In this special case, unlike in federal elections, voting is not required by law and, once the results are in, Parliament is not technically obligated to act in response.

The plebiscite idea began as an alternative to a free vote in Parliament, a substitute proposed by former Prime Minister Tony Abbott. When Abbott was ousted as leader of the Liberal Party—which, despite its name, is relatively conservative—current Prime Minister Malcolm Turnbull agreed to continue supporting the proposal to appease all factions of his party.

"They've been trying to stall this for yonks," Jasper Lindell, an editor at ANU's student publication *Woroni*, told *The Politic*. Turnbull needed the support of right-wing Liberals, whose champion had been Abbott, to retain his governing majority.

The original Liberal campaign commitment was to conduct a proper plebiscite on same-sex marriage legalization, where registered voters would be required to turn out at ballot boxes.

"That was voted down in Parliament," Lindell said, "so what they've done is authorize this postal thing with ministerial power." What started as a political maneuver to avoid intra-partisan strife has now grown into one of Australia's largest public issues.

"It's completely abnormal for the way Westminster parliamentary systems work," said University of Melbourne student Daniel Beratis, but "it's dominating the agenda."

Despite the unusual form of the vote, citizens on both sides are determined to participate, according to Dean of the University of Melbourne Law School Carolyn Evans. As the closing deadline for ballot submission approaches, both "Yes" and "No" campaign groups race to encourage voter participation. University campuses are no exception to the spike in activism.

Evans noted in an email to *The Politic* that, in her experience, most faculty and students tend to lean in favor of marriage equality. According to Lewis, Beratis, and Lindell, student engagement has become a key issue for the movement.

"We've been holding events every week," said Lewis, who is heavily involved in organizing at ANU and for the National Union of Students. "It's been a massive mobilization, which is really fantastic."

Many young adults were not enrolled in the voting registry prior to the plebiscite, which would have handicapped the demographic's ability to influence the results.

"Every election, there is always a big campaign to get young people to enroll to vote. [For] this one, there was a remarkable surge in young people enrolling," commented Lindell. "That was the focus of the 'Yes' campaign."

> "For the first time, Australia may join English-speaking allies in Canada, the UK, and the U.S. in recognizing same-sex marriage."

On university campuses, student activists have taken part in door-knocking, phone banking, and "all that sort of boots-on-the-ground stuff," Lindell said. Campus groups have organized events like "voting parties" to ensure that students—many of whom may not have much experience using the postal system—are actually able to submit the survey once enrolled. Organizers aim to make the voting process as accessible and effortless as possible.

"They stick on a barbecue in the common area on campus, you bring in your form, tick 'Yes,' and put it in a secure ballot box that will be taken to the post office," Lindell said.

Most university communities across Australia are

strongly in favor of the resolution. Even the schools' administrations are taking a stand. The Academic Board at the University of Melbourne officially resolved in mid-September to support marriage equality. According to Beratis, this decision was an important milestone for the school in supporting people of all backgrounds and identities.

Still, Evans pointed out that such a heated debate can take a toll on invested students.

"Unfortunately, there have been some ugly campaigns around the vote which have had an impact on student wellbeing," he explained.

In September, *The Guardian* reported that a "No" protest and a "Yes" counter-protest at the University of Sydney had escalated and police were called to the scene. While Beratis had not witnessed any abnormally hostile student politics in Melbourne, the Sydney altercation surprised him. He knew "in the abstract" that people on both sides of the issue were passionate. Even so, learning about the intensity of the confrontation was a serious realization for him.

In interviews with *The Politic*, the three students were confident that their universities were generally supportive atmospheres for LGBTI students.

"Every corkboard on campus has got a 'Yes' campaign [sign], and the academics are behind it, too," Lindell said of ANU. "But the University of Sydney is known for that sort of confrontational politics, which isn't replicated here."

Beratis conceded that, as a progressive campus in a progressive city and state, the University of Melbourne is an ideological bubble. Because the plebiscite is voluntary, student activists at the University of Melbourne focused on participation.

"We're not campaigning to 'No' voters," Beratis said. "We're campaigning to 'Yes' voters who haven't filled out their ballots yet."

He also noted that some of the "No" campaign's rhetoric could be painful, particularly for LGBTI and questioning students.

"To some people, it's quite distressing to see the level of homophobia in our community," Lewis said. At the same time, she noted that the issue served as a powerful community builder.

"There are people who are really energized by [the debate]," she explained.

Beratis also expressed sympathy for people who lacked support networks during a time in which anti-equality rhetoric was particularly loud.

"The arguments against marriage equality to my eyes don't have a basis," he said. "And they can be quite harmful and quite hurtful."

Much of the "No" movement's opposition to the measure, according to Lindell, is centered on freedom of speech and freedom of religion. One of the campaign's major slogans, plastered on billboards and televised messaging, reads, "It's okay to say no."

> "'I think that if it does go through, it would be politically suicidal [for parliamentarians] not to vote 'Yes,'' Lindell said. 'And I think representatives are acutely aware of that.'"

"The 'No' campaign likes to pull out, 'We're being silenced,'" Lindell said. Citing another analysis by *The Guardian Australia*, he noted that the "No" campaign has reportedly been mentioned in newspapers more frequently than the "Yes" movement. He shrugged.

Most projections predict a clear "Yes" victory when the Australian Bureau of Statistics releases the official results on November 15. Evans noted that the Bureau has already seen a remarkably high number of responses, partly due to engagement from young people—a testament to the work of youth outreach campaigns like those in Melbourne and Canberra. According to the Australian Electoral Commission, two thirds of all new voter registrations in the weeks leading up to the enrollment deadline came from Australians between the ages of 18 and 24.

"Most people think this survey is awfully ridiculous and that Parliament should just walk into the chamber tomorrow and legislate it, which they could do," Lindell said. "If everyone walked in and voted on their conscience, it would be legislated. Both Malcolm Turnbull, the prime minister, and Bill Shorten, the opposition leader, support marriage equality."

Assuming Parliament waits for the result of the survey, which the government has spent 120 million dollars

to operate, it will then face the introduction of legislation this winter to reform the law on marriage. Parliamentarians are not legally required to heed the outcome of the plebiscite, but there will likely be strong pressure from their constituents to do so.

"I think that if it does go through, it would be politically suicidal [for parliamentarians] not to vote 'Yes,'" Lindell said. "And I think representatives are acutely aware of that."

Beratis agrees that the stakes are high, even though the survey is non-binding.

"At the end of the day," he said, "I don't think [the non-binding nature of the survey] is going to matter."

As the likelihood of a "Yes" majority gradually becomes more certain, Liberal policymakers have indicated a focus on protecting religious freedoms if the legislation becomes reality. To Evans, who studies the relationship between law and religion, these concerns don't have much standing.

"Same-sex marriage will make relatively little difference to religious freedom, particularly if religious organisations are exempted from having to conduct religious marriages for same-sex couples," she wrote in an email.

Australian law already prohibits indirect service providers (such as florists and bakeries) from discriminating against same-sex couples. Evans said that there are drawbacks to the plebiscite.

"A popular vote is not the place to have detailed discussions about the way in which conflicting rights would be resolved," she explained.

She added that the argument over how to accommodate all citizens' constitutional rights has detracted from the substance of the vote itself. Lindell, too, said that the "No" campaign has emphasized the defense of conservative Australians' civil rights.

"The 'No' campaign has certainly tried to use that as a reason not to vote 'Yes,'" Lindell wrote. "I don't think they've done that very successfully, but that's certainly been something that they've held onto to avoid confronting [the direct issue]…And so the 'Yes' campaign has said, 'Well, actually, that's not important; what we're voting on is this."

Whatever the result, Lewis, Beratis, and Lindell voiced their enthusiasm for the postal survey's unique effectiveness in mobilizing young people to register to vote and develop an active voice in Australian politics.

"Most of [the new enrollments] would have been young people who would be more likely to vote progressively," Beratis said. "Since voting is compulsory, even though people may not get their ballots in for this postal survey, at the next election they are going to have to vote and that's going to have…an impact on elections to come."

At ANU, the survey is catalyzing student action across the board.

"So many people who were not politically involved previously now are, and they're really standing in support," Lewis said. "Activism has started seeping into other parts of university life…I think maybe this tells us that our conservative politicians need to watch out, especially on social issues. I don't think young people are going to stand for it anymore."

Lindell also recognized the value of such an "experience of the power of democracy" at the beginning of a young adult's political life.

"This is their first engagement in voting in anything in Australia," he remarked. "They sort of see this as a real positive change that they could be a part of, a positive moment in history."

"'This is their first engagement in voting in anything in Australia,' he remarked. 'They sort of see this as a real positive change that they could be a part of, a positive moment in history.'"

Yalies debate finance and consulting

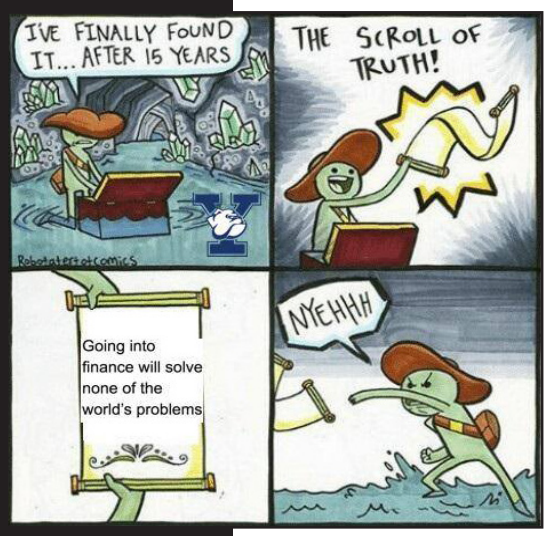
GOING CORPORATE

BY **MERY CONCEPCION**

ALL IT TAKES IS A QUICK VISIT TO THE YALE MEME FACEBOOK PAGE TO OBSERVE THE DISDAIN MANY STUDENTS HAVE FOR FINANCE AND CONSULTING. AMONG DINING HALL LABELING MISHAPS AND DIGS AT DIRECTED STUDIES, YOU WILL FIND CAREFULLY CURATED MEMES PORTRAYING FINANCE AND CONSULTING AS INDUSTRIES OF CONFORMITY, IMMORALITY, AND ELITISM.

The Politic reached out to some Yale meme creators to get their take.

"I think a lot of Yalies go into careers like [finance and consulting] without anything approaching a social conscience–they do it because they care about prestige and/or want financial stability and/or see that everyone's applying for something similar and just go with the herd," Henry Robinson '19, the creator of the "scroll of truth" finance meme, wrote to *The Politic*. "I don't think memes are meant to be a substitute for actual discourse or conversation. I doubt that anyone who does finance or consulting and saw my meme had their minds changed in any significant way, and that wasn't really my goal."



Critics of finance often claim that a culture of pre-professionalism at Yale, evident in the presence of on-campus recruiting and the race to build strong resumes and earn prestigious internships, encourages many Yalies to pursue these fields.

"Students [are turning towards more] straight-forward degree paths such as finance or business versus industries or majors that have less of a direct path like history, for example, or anthropology," Eli Rami '19, a former intern at the consulting firm Deloitte, said in an interview with *The Politic*.

Data from class surveys conducted by the Office of Career Strategies for 2013-2016 show that the top three post-graduation employment industries were education, finance and consulting. Finance and consulting constitute just under 30 percent of post-graduate first destinations, with an average of 16.75 percent of the graduating class going straight into finance and 12.45 percent going to consulting.

This rush towards consulting and finance is not unique to Yale. Between 2006 and 2011, Harvard sent an average of 22.6 percent of its graduates into finance and an average of 14.8 percent into consulting, numbers slightly higher than Yale's. Princeton, on the other hand, saw a whopping 38 percent of their graduating class go into financial services between 2000 and 2010.



"Compared to our peer schools that have a strong undergraduate specific business programs like the University of Pennsylvania, which has Wharton, they may be putting 30 percent of their class, 40 percent of their class right into finance because that's what their curriculum is aimed for. Yale doesn't really do that," Jeanine Dames, Director of the Office of Career Strategy, told *The Politic*. "It fluctuates. Finance and education duke it out every year...Consulting usually comes in around number three. There's this really interesting trend of technology growing and this really interesting trend of healthcare growing."

Some students suspect that many Yalies choose to work in finance because of the field's significant compensation, not because of a genuine interest in the work. This possible motivation fuels popular criticisms that those who enter the field have "sold their souls" and given in to corporate greed.

"Certainly there are greedy people in finance, I'll certainly acknowledge that," said Michael Pascutti, a professor of Economics who teaches Introduction to Corporate Finance, in an interview with *The Politic*. "I worked there for a long time. There are greedy people in lots

THERE ARE GREEDY PEOPLE IN LOTS OF PLACES IN THE WORLD THOUGH, NOT JUST FINANCE. THEY DON'T HAVE A MONOPOLY ON GREED.

THEY CAN TAP INTO THE ANXIETIES THAT JUNIORS AND SENIORS FEEL WHEN FACED WITH THE DAUNTING TASK OF DETERMINING THEIR IMMEDIATE FUTURES.

Dames made a distinction between industry and function. The role students perform at their individual jobs may differ from the stereotypical role associated with a field.

"Even though...12 percent of the class of 2017 went into technology as an industry, when you look at the function, their actual job, less than six percent were actually doing programming," she told The Politic.

The industry-job distinction adds nuance to the consulting and finance debate. Not all students who decide to go into finance, for example, are working in banking or sales and trading. Some may opt to work in marketing or Human Resources, where they will have a function that they are qualified for and enjoy while meeting their financial needs.

Since the beginning of on-campus recruiting about 25 to 30 years ago, recruiters have been able to draw a sizable portion of Yale undergraduates through their expertly targeted recruiting tactics. They can tap into the anxieties that juniors and seniors feel when faced with the daunting task of determining their immediate futures.

"I think [finance and consulting] locked into that as thinking 'we could be your gap period opportunity.' They marketed it well. Whether or not it's the right gap year opportunity for students, individual students, is a totally different discussion: it's right for some, it's definitely not right for others," Dames explained.



Overwhelmingly negative campus attitudes towards finance and consulting can add anxiety to the already grueling process of choosing a postgraduate path.

"The thing that differentiates us from a school like Wharton, for instance, is that people at Wharton are very open about the fact that, yes, I have these goals, I'm studying economics, I want to go corporate," Rami said. At Yale, however, "you have to lie, you have to lay down your criticisms of corporate America and then you have to say like, 'Oh yeah, you know, I feel super conflicted about doing this' and then you get your corporate job."

Rami's observations illustrate how students have a negative perception of the decision to "go corporate." The fact that it was difficult to find students willing to be interviewed for this piece is a testament to this negative stigma.



Dames emphasized that career paths are not one-size-fits-all. In an effort to diversify the career search while balancing large on-campus recruiting operations, the Yale Office of Career Strategies has been promoting networking events that feature smaller, "boutique," consulting and finance firms, start-ups, non-profits and government employers.

"A lot of the reason we started collecting and publishing data was to dispel some of the myths and also for students to realize, you can have a career as a performing artist, there are resources to do it, there are people you can talk to" said Dames.

For now, the debate about the merits of corporate careers continues, both in memes and reality.

YOU HAVE TO LIE, YOU HAVE TO LAY DOWN YOUR CRITICISMS OF CORPORATE AMERICA AND THEN YOU HAVE TO SAY LIKE, 'OH YEAH, YOU KNOW, I FEEL SUPER CONFLICTED ABOUT DOING THIS' AND THEN YOU GET YOUR CORPORATE JOB.

STATE CAPTURED

South Africa's War Against a Shadow Government

BY **PETER ROTHPLETZ**

LAST JUNE, I WATCHED a pair of makeshift coffins crowdsurf across Boipatong Stadium in Gauteng, South Africa. Thousands of people, clad in crimson berets and faux military regalia, took turns passing the empty boxes overhead as young women danced onstage to Rihanna's *Kiss it Better*. The rally was billed as an opportunity to watch Julius Malema, president of South Africa's third largest political bloc, the Economic Freedom Fighters, commemorate lives lost during the 1976 Soweto Uprising. But by mid-afternoon, it had erupted into an outright referendum on the country's ruling party, flavored by a curious mix of Afropop and *The Billboard Hot 100*. As one of the caskets floated toward me above the crowd, I could make out a short declaration scrawled in red: *REST IN PAIN ZUPTA*.

"The President is a monster," Mangaliso Nolusu, a college student at North-West University, explained to me on the outskirts of the rally. "He's beyond corrupt…he's stealing everything he can."

"State capture" regularly dominates the headlines of major news agencies operating out of Johannesburg, Cape Town, and Durban. The term has come to refer to an alleged criminal plot—launched by an Indian-born South African business family, the Guptas, and their company, Oakbay Investments—to form a "shadow government" alongside a complicit President Jacob Zuma. The alliance has come to be known as "#Zupta."

It's difficult to summarize the whole affair, but imagine a trove of leaked emails à la the U.S. 2016 presidential election (on steroids) implicating the country's leader, his allies, and a British PR firm in an alleged conspiracy to purposely inflame racial tensions through fake Twitter accounts. And if the emails are to be believed, the efforts were all an attempt to deflect attention from the corruption of a myriad of public officials and state enterprises. The matter could inspire more than a few plotlines on *House of Cards*.

In the midst of this sordid political drama, the people have suffered. In 2017, the number of South Africans living in poverty increased to 30.4 million—more than 55 percent of the country's total population. The unemployment rate, now at approximately 26.6 percent, stands at a 14-year high. And, according to Statistician-General Dr. Pali Lehohla, "anemic economic growth" and "educational outcome failures" will only exacerbate current financial stagnation, which is unduly taxing on populations of color.

The Guptas and President Zuma have long-maintained their innocence, but an upcoming African National Congress (ANC) elective conference may finally bring about the beginning of the end for both. But even their ouster would leave the country still festering with deep, open wounds.



PHOTO BY **PETER ROTHPLETZ**

THE STATE CAPTURE SCANDAL starts with a set of fraternal billionaires.

Brothers Ajay, Atul, and Rajesh Gupta moved to Johannesburg from Saharanpur in 1993, hoping to expand their family tech startup, Sahara Computers, into a multi-industry empire. The gamble paid off, and within a few years they had bought up a score of mining and engineering companies, a high-end game lodge, and a 24-hour news network.

The trio began to garner the South African press' attention when stories bubbled up detailing their use of a government air force base for a private wedding. Revelations that the brothers had gradually come to employ President Zuma's son, Duduzane, daughter, Duduzile, and one of his wives, Bongi, only intensified worries of state capture: a rumored network of bribes, kickbacks, money laundering, and compromised public officials.

Then, in March 2016, Deputy Finance Minister Mcebisi Jonas alleged the Guptas had offered him approximately 43 million dollars in exchange for future loyalty.

"'You will have to work with [us].' Basically that's what [the Guptas] said," Mcebisi asserted in a July 2017 interview with *BBC News*.

It was around this time that Bell-Pottinger—a now-defunct public relations firm—set up shop in Johannesburg. Hired by Ajay, Atul, and Rajesh, the outfit was tasked with cleaning up the image of Oakbay Investments for a humble 130,000 dollars a month. In response, consultants attempted to dredge up ethnic tensions in the nation that suffered through apartheid.

"This is a company that once bragged about its ability to 'drown out negative content,'" Phillip de Wet, an Associate Editor at *The Mail & Guardian* who has chronicled the state capture saga since its inception, explained in an online correspondence with *The Politic*.

Prior to filing for bankruptcy in September 2017, Bell-Pottinger was subject to a number of high-profile accusations of suspect business practices. The most eye-catching include the use of "sockpuppets"—or false online identities—to strategically edit clients' Wikipedia pages, and the negotiation of a series of contracts with the U.S. Department of Defense to covertly produce fake al-Qaeda style propaganda videos in Iraq. In retrospect, however, the controversies are rather tame, compared to a cache of leaked electronic communications obtained by the South African press earlier this year.

In one explosive email exchange between Duduzane, President Zuma's son, and Victoria Geoghegan, Bell-Pottinger's lead partner on the Guptas' Oakbay account, there is evidence of a coordinated effort to sow discord by manipulating the national conversation. The emails suggest that the pair sought to pull public scrutiny away from alleged state capture by ramping up demands for "economic emancipation"–pushing the "grassroots" to rebel against "economic apartheid." The firm even guided the political rhetoric of Gupta-Zuma loyalists in the ANC.

"The country is in a bad place right now

"I can tell you how sneakily pernicious their tactics were," Adam Krok '19, an Ethics, Politics, & Economics major from Johannesburg, said in an interview with *The Politic*. "[South African populists] consistently refer to 'white monopoly power,' the idea that business lies predominantly in white hands, and through the influence of money, white people control the government. It's prima facie a convincing argument because of the very real, enormous discrepancy of wealth between black and white people in South Africa."

"It was only much later I learned that that direct phrase was started from [Bell-Pottinger] and the Guptas, as a diversion tactic to keep politics away from the Gupta's enormous influence over Zuma. Blame white business, while we, the Guptas, continue to loot the state," Krok continued.

Indeed, the legacies of colonialism and apartheid still haunt Desmond Tutu's "rainbow nation," but the manner of vitriolic racial animus that's popped up in the last two years is dangerous–fueled, at least in part, by automated social media bots that some journalists claim were loosed by Bell-Pottinger. Daily Maverick reporter Jean le Roux tracked dozens of fake, propaganda accounts for months, and ultimately published a report asserting the parallel activity between different profiles indicated a coordinated troll campaign.

Bell-Pottinger has since gone bankrupt, as word of its actions in South Africa resulted in a mass exodus of clients, shareholders, and senior staff. Chief Executive James Henderson resigned and Victoria Geoghegan was fired. Unfortunately, the damage has been done.

"The exit of Bell Pottinger from the fray has made little difference to the dirty propaganda being used," de Wet explained. "The misinformation websites are still going, the Twitter trolls are still around, and the lies are still being told."

ALL THE WHILE, the President has carried on.

"It takes remarkable cunning to survive more than 700 corruption allegations. Zuma is one of the smartest political operators in the game," Krok said with a frustrated smirk.

The leader displayed a near-catlike ability to routinely outmaneuver career-killing political scandals even before



PHOTO BY **PETER ROTHPLETZ**

. But I have so much hope. I really do."

he ascended to power in May 2009. He has overcome 783 corruption and racketeering charges, a 2005 rape charge, no less than six no-confidence votes, and massive fallout following two midnight cabinet reshuffles that cost the country billions of dollars.

This past August, during the South African parliament's six motion of no-confidence in Zuma, MPs were permitted to cast blind votes – an unprecedented move.

"This meant that even the ANC members who despised Zuma could vote against him without fear of party retaliation. Yet Zuma still survived!" Krok continued.

"I imagine the ANC MPs who still voted for Zuma under the blind vote must be in as corrupt a boat as the president" Krok said.. "Freed to vote with their consciences, party allegiance was no longer a good excuse."

De Wet reiterated Krok's advice to never count against the embattled leader: "It's fascinating to watch Zuma turn every fiasco to his advantage. For instance, it looks like he'll defend himself against ancient criminal charges by arguing that [a KPMG forensic audit into his finances] can't be trusted because of its brush with his friends, the Guptas."

"With a KPMG report as the core of the corruption case against him, and with KPMG's reputation now shot... hey presto, Zuma shouldn't have to face those criminal charges."

The leader is a fascinating case study—an unapologetic polygamist whose political savvy is predicated on no more than a sixth-grade education. It's also important to note he spent ten years imprisoned on Robben Island for anti-apartheid activism. Since then, he has masterfully risen through the ranks of South African politics, largely through a calculated network of patronage and blackmail. This December, however, Zuma will have no choice but to step down as the head of the ANC, having served his allocated two terms.

"Right now it is all about the year-end elective conference," de Wet told *The Politic*, "if Zuma does not get a loyal defender as the new party leader he is, quite simply, screwed."

Over the summer, the leader publicly lost the support of the ANC's two alliance partners: the South African Communist party and trade union federation COSATU. He also managed to unite the country's two leading opposition blocs—the hard left Economic Freedom Fighters and the center-right Democratic Alliance—as a bizarre political odd-couple dead set against him.

And so, pressed on all sides, the outgoing leader has moved to endorse his ex-wife, Nkosazana Dlamini-Zuma, over his own Deputy President, Cyril Ramaphosa, to be his successor.

More than a month out from the contest, it's still too early to offer a real prediction. But de Wet smells blood in the water: "the easiest possible political win for a new incumbent is to promise to 'renew' the ANC, and prove willingness to do so by crucifying Zuma."

MORE THAN A FEW parents brought their children to the EFF event at Boipatong Stadium last June. Friendly teenagers, sporting *Marvel Comics* t-shirts and wool caps, roamed about the arena in loose huddles. The rally-goers were frustrated, fed up with a sluggish economy, racial inequality, and years of entrenched government corruption.

But the affair wasn't excessively raucous. Those gathered were happy warriors, motivated by a genuine faith in their political system. Most I spoke with would be hardpressed to believe their country is another Zimbabwe or Zambia. They told me they see the Guptas, Zuma, and Bell-Pottinger not as defining features of their politics, but as a problem that can be defeated. They know South Africa will overcome.

Maria Mokoena brought her ten year-old son, Lesedi, with her to the Boipatong rally. We spoke early that morning, before the floating coffins captured the crowd's attention. "The country is in a bad place right now," she told me as Lesedi pulled at her sleeve. "But I have so much hope. I really do."

DISRUPTION

DISRUPTION

DISRUPTION

CAMBRIDGE ANALYTIC

INFLUENCE ON YOUR VO

"THERE IS NO WAY THIS COMPANY CAN BE LEGAL,"

CA'S OTE

BY **SIMON SOROS**

said David Carroll, a professor at the Parsons School of Design, in an interview with *The Politic*. Carroll is currently suing Cambridge Analytica, the mysterious data analytics firm that helped elect President Donald Trump.

Shrouded in changing stories, accusations of military connections, and the mystery of a hedge fund billionaire's money, Cambridge Analytica has emerged as a leviathan in the wake of Trump's shock victory. Carroll is one of many critics who are suspicious of the firm. But the company itself maintains that its unique data collection and deployment methods are entirely legal and represent a natural progression of the advertising industry.

Cambridge Analytica, founded in 2014, creates targeted advertisements from the data it collects. The company has three divisions: Commercial, Political, and Society. The first two divisions are publicly listed on the company's website, but no information exists about the third. *The Politic* only learned of it thanks to an interview for this article with a former employee.

The firm uses a controversial tool called psychographics, which measures personality. Cambridge Analytica claims that it has built in-depth psychological profiles of 230 million American voters, using 5,000 data points on each. This data includes the voter's preferences on social media, news sources, and purchase history of products like cars. These data points are then used to create an OCEAN five-factor personality model; it measures Openness, Conscientiousness, Extroversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism.

In a presentation at the 2016 Concordia Summit, CEO Alexander Nix explained that Cambridge Analytica's use of psychographics is based on the belief that voters' choice are influenced in part by personality, not just demographics and geography as other data analytics companies are inclined to think.

The personality models, as well as people's demographic and geographic information, are used "to nuance…messaging to resonate more effectively with key audience groups," Nix continued.

This strategy is called microtargeting. When put into practice, microtargeting ensures that a highly neurotic and conscientious voter is shown a fear-based commercial of a burglar breaking into his or her home instead of a legal defense of the Second Amendment, or that an anxious voter is shown a message emphasizing the dangers of the self-proclaimed Islamic State.

Critics of microtargeting see Cambridge Analytica's actions as intrusive.

"People do not understand how their entire lives are being modelled," Carroll said.

In an interview with *The Politic*, Swiss journalist Hannes Grassegger said that he believes Cambridge Analytica is forging a whole new discipline of advertising.

"What really starts now is personalizing information," said Grassegger. As a result, he explained, the world will start to morph into a "virtual reality [where] your information environment is adapting to you."

He gave a not-too-futuristic analogy of a room in which the lighting is changed according to the

PEOPLE DO NOT UNDERSTAND HOW THEIR ENTIRE LIVES ARE

mood of the person who walks in. "What if five people come into the room?" he asked. "Whose mood will be chosen for the lighting?"

Grassegger said he is concerned that microtargeting provides different voters with different information. Ideally, Grassegger explained, "politics is about the common ground. In democracy, we are debating something that relates to everyone."

He also expressed unease about the risk of Cambridge Analytica's data getting into the hands of third parties. He said there have been "cases in Estonia where people have been physically targeted based on their online information. Even if it's just a wacky company, they can still actually buy data on American citizens and trade it to whatever entity."

Still, a former Cambridge Analytica employee, speaking to *The Politic* on condition of anonymity, argued that these concerns stem from a lack of awareness about data analytics.

"In reality, everyone's info is being bought and sold," the former employee said. "What Cambridge Analytica is doing is nothing new."

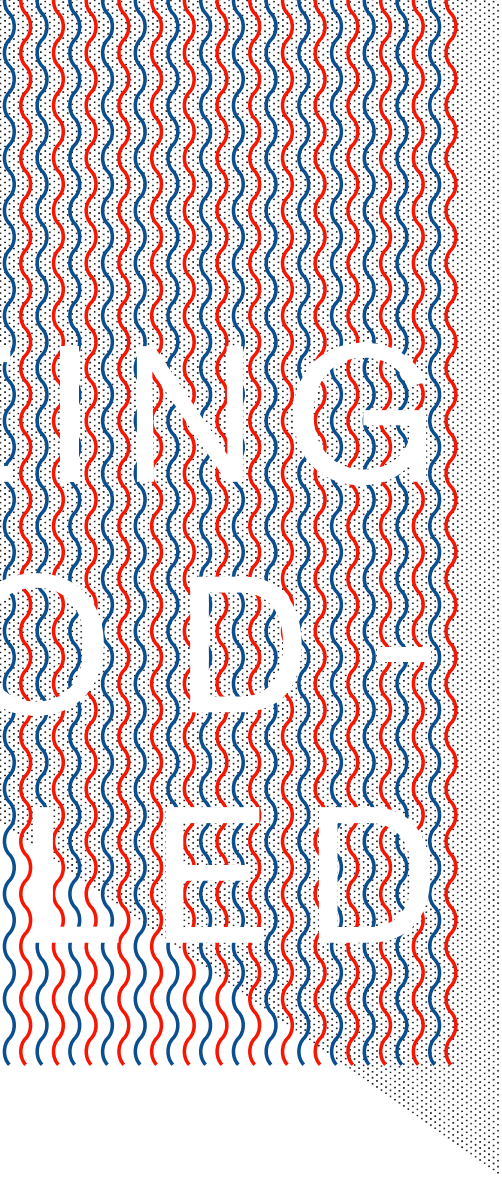
Since Cambridge Analytica buys most of its data from other firms, such as credit card companies and eBay, privacy concerns directed specifically at the company are misplaced.

Nonetheless, Grassegger said he was hopeful that fears about Cambridge Analytica might prompt further discussion about the dangers surrounding the lack of security in data analytics.

"Thanks to the beautiful claims this company has made, all of a sudden people understand how potentially dangerous this can become," he said.

Some even allege that Cambridge Analytica helped Russia target disinformation during last year's presidential election. The company is currently cooperating with Special Counsel Robert Mueller's investigation into Russian election interference in 2016. So far, no evidence suggests that Cambridge Analytica was either working with Russia or spreading false information. But on October 26, Nix revealed that he reached out to Wikileaks founder Julian Assange about releasing Hillary Clinton's 33,000 missing emails. Assange confirmed that he was approached, but said that he rejected the request.

Although many data analytics firms face similar ethical questions, Cambridge Analytica has raised particular suspicion with its practices. The company has been accused of



deleting displayed projects on the Cambridge Analytica website and backtracked on its claim that it used psychographics in the 2016 election after critics raised concerns about the legality of the practice. (Cambridge Analytica recently reversed the second claim and now maintains that it did use psychographics.)

Even so, Carroll said "a lot of people really want to be skeptical of [Cambridge Analytica] just to be skeptical, so that it doesn't get power. They want to discredit this company because it's dangerous to mythologize its power."

Similarly, Carroll noted that "academics are very hesitant to admit anything capable of this company because it only encourages them," while traditional pollsters know that acknowledging its success "would destabilize their whole discipline." But perhaps most importantly, people simply "don't want to admit that propaganda works, that we fit into psychological patterns, that we are predictable and can be sorted. No one wants to admit that this is possible."

It might not be. Some are skeptical that the firm has the ability to convince voters based on their personalities.

"Psychographics are a very small part of what they do," said the former employee.

They explained that "most of the population gets around the same score," offering the most convincing claim so far that the "secret sauce" Nix uses to sell the company is more like grocery-store mayonnaise.

"In reality, it is extremely difficult to predict someone's personality," they said.

At a post-election panel last December, Matt Oczkowski, Cambridge Analytica's Head of Product, maintained that his firm did not use psychographics for the Trump campaign. And when Carroll requested and reviewed the data the company had on him, he saw no psychographic scores.

But if not psychographics, what helped Ted Cruz rise from thirteenth to second in the Republican primary after hiring Cambridge Analytica's? What caused Trump's campaign to increase spending on the company from 250,000 dollars in August 2016 to five million dollars the next month? These two cases indicate that Cambridge Analytica is no fraud. Perhaps the answer to the company's success is less sexy: They might just be a very good data analytics firm.

The controversy might be overblown. There are credible claims that Barack Obama's campaign, using a firm called DSPolitical, used micro-targeting on a similar scale in 2012.

"It should have been a scandal back then," Grassegger argued, although he noted that "it was a very different context," since fewer people were using smartphones and social media.

Facebook has been criticized for allowing so-called "dark posts." Dark posts are bits of content that are only seen by one target individual and cannot be traced.

"Cambridge Analytica is just a diversion," journalist McKenzie Funk told *The Politic*. "Facebook is the main issue."

Facebook went public in 2012, and, since then, the company has been increasingly reliant on ads for its profits. Funk suggested that the recent media attention devoted to the quantity and power of dark posts and other Facebook advertisements might be Mark Zuckerberg's "Frankenstein moment," where he realizes how powerful the machine he has built can be.

Recently, Zuckerberg announced a series of reforms and changes to increase the transparency of dark posts. But Funk is skeptical.

"It's not going to change ad targeting that much," he said. "The core of the entire business is granularity on people and selling ads to those people based on that granularity, so that is not going to go away."

Psychographics aside, questions

SINCE DATA FLOWS AROUND LIKE AIR,

still remain about Cambridge Analytica. Perhaps the most pressing involves the company's military links: Cambridge Analytica is a subsidiary of Strategic Communication Laboratories Group (SCL), an international military contractor. According to writer Sue Halpern, who spoke with *The Politic*, the U.S. military used SCL psychological operations during the Afghanistan War to sway Afghan citizens' opinions.

The former employee described the company as "pretty transparent" about its affiliation with SCL. If they are public knowledge, are these ties a serious issue?

Many would argue they are as serious as it gets. Carroll calls this fact "the shocking thing people don't want to admit."

He expressed concern that tools employed by the military are now being used to sell fabric softener and swing elections.

"Cambridge Analytica is a brand that's very useful to obscure the military roots of this company," Carroll said. "However, that falls apart the minute you request your data, because you get it from SCL."

SCL's status as a British corporation raises further fears about the movement of data across borders. (Despite its influence in the American presidential election, Cambridge Analytica is named not for Cambridge, Massachusetts but for the University of Cambridge in the UK.)

"Americans should be offended our data has left the country," Carroll declared. "Since data flows around like air, whose laws control it?"

Since Cambridge Analytica transferred U.S. voter information to Britain during last year's campaign, the firm's ability to use that data would have been constrained by British law. There are limits to what you can do with profiling in Britain, and according to Carroll, "from British legal minds, they don't think what Cambridge Analytica did is lawful. It can't be compliant to regulators' rules and guidance."

Grassegger was less certain, saying that "the legal experts we contacted were not sure whether you could practically construct loopholes" in British and EU law that would make Cambridge Analytica's activities permissible.

Despite being involved in multiple investigations and the subject of several lawsuits, Cambridge Analytica "has not curtailed its activity in the least," Carroll said.

But the company's ownership structure has done little to quell suspicion. Grassegger related claims

WHOSE LAWS

that "some of the...SCL branches have been partly owned by people close to Putin." He did, however, qualify these allegations, saying, "I did not find a definitive conclusion."

It is widely known that conservative billionaire Robert Mercer and his daughter Rebekah own 90 percent of Cambridge Analytica. They were linked with *Breitbart News* chairman Stephen Bannon, who served on Cambridge Analytica's board and subsequently in the Trump administration, although Robert Mercer appeared to distance himself from Bannon's views in a letter explaining his recent decision to sell *Breitbart* shares and step down as co-CEO of the hedge fund Renaissance Technologies. Carroll noted that Bannon still has links to Cambridge Analytica, citing an outstanding loan.

Jane Mayer, a writer for *The New Yorker* who profiled Robert Mercer, wrote in an email to *The Politic* that "the Mercers will use Cambridge Analytica to advance their candidates and at the moment, they're backing the slate of populist nationalists drafted by Steve Bannon."

Cambridge Analytica's empowerment of right-wing causes is not limited to the U.S. The company was also associated with the Leave. EU campaign in the lead-up to last year's EU referendum in the UK. Nigel Farage, one of the most zealous proponents of Brexit, has campaigned for both Trump and Roy Moore, the Bannon and Mercer-backed candidate for U.S. Senator from Alabama. What's more, Andy Wigmore, Director of Communications for Leave.EU, said he would join a campaign for California secession. As Carroll put it, "the bad boys of Brexit are going to continue to work in the U.S."

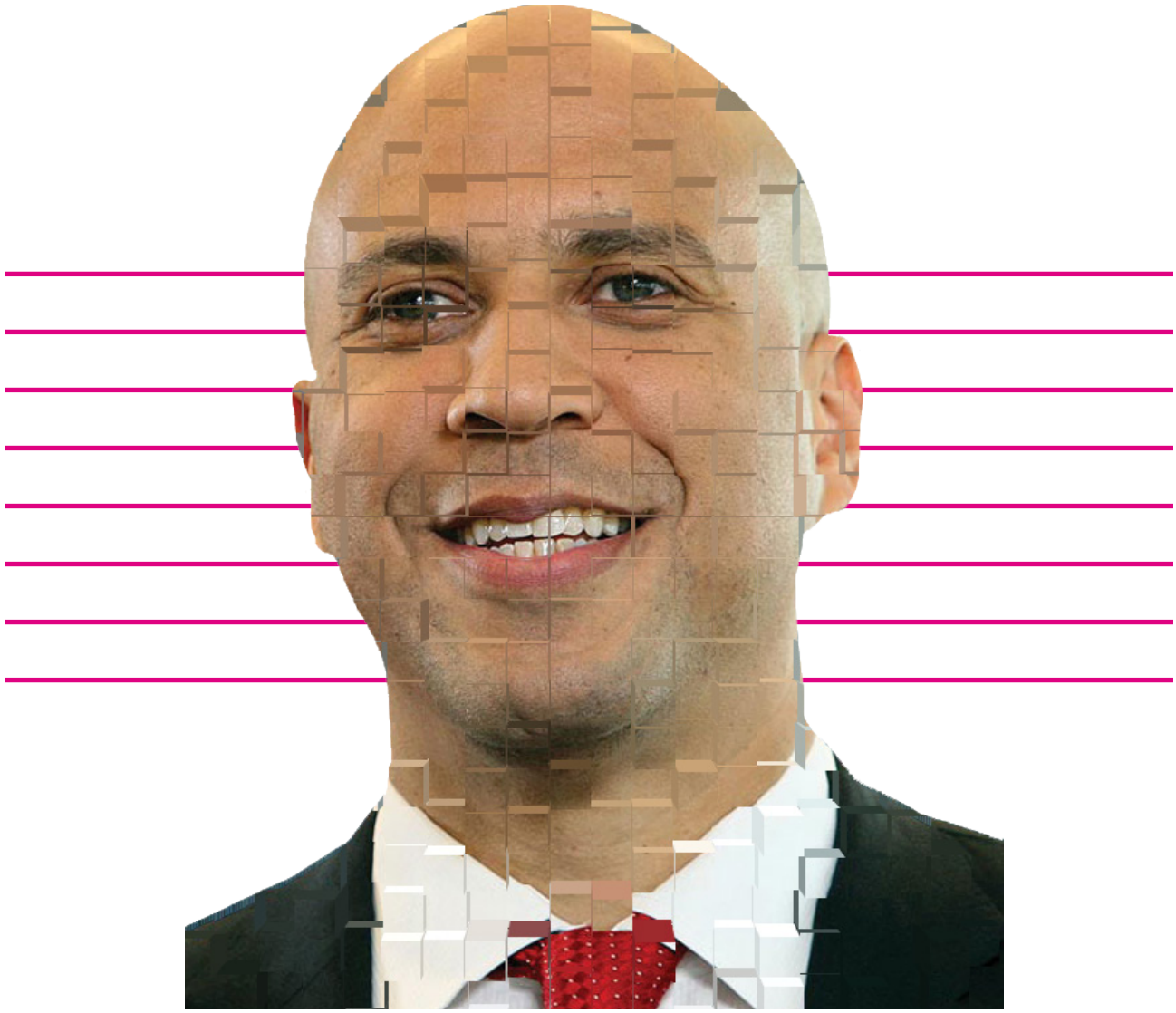
Bannon and Mercer are looking to run hard-right America First candidates, Halpern said, in order to make traditional conservatives look weak and cultivate a new alt-Republican party. Cambridge Analytica might be the medium for them to succeed.

Or it might not. Halpern described Cambridge Analytica as a "gun for hire." The former employee stated that the company will "take whoever's offering the most money. They don't have any agenda." Cambridge Analytica has worked on liberal causes around the world, but in America, it remains unlikely that Mercer will allow the Democrats to purchase the company's services.

Nonetheless, the data analytics industry will likely follow in Cambridge Analytica's footsteps. Despite the issues surrounding the company and its tactics, Halpern says Democrats and Republicans alike will soon be reliant on similar firms. Facebook's announced reforms will not stop dark posts altogether, and data analytics firms will continue to thrive.

"Is everyone going to do this now?" Halpern asked rhetorically. She was sure of the answer. "Yes."

"IS EVERYONE GOING TO DO THIS NOW?" HALPERN ASKED RHETORICALLY. SHE WAS SURE OF THE ANSWER. "YES."



AN INTERVIEW WITH CORY BOOKER

BY **LINA VOLIN**

WHAT IS IT THAT KEEPS YOU GOING? WHAT ARE THE MAIN SOURCES OF INSPIRATION FOR YOU IN YOUR WORK?

BOOKER: I think this has been one of the most inspirational periods for me, as an adult. I've seen horrible, horrible policies like the Muslim ban, but then I go out to the Dulles Airport, and I see hundreds and hundreds of people protesting and literally people of all different backgrounds cheering Muslim families who are coming off of planes and just celebrating the truth of we are and showing what America really is, and what America really looks like. I saw guys with kipas and tzitzit hanging out cheering Muslim families who were coming in. So whether it's having the whole day

of listening to a very mean-spirited inauguration speech about carnage in America, but, in the next day, seeing the beauty in America where hundreds of thousands of people are marching all over the country in the Women's March. Often it's the darkest times that become the most inspiring times because you see the goodness of people really coming out. You see people not allowing darkness or despair to have the last word, and let the last word be hope, let the last word be activism, let the last word be love.

FOR THOSE OF US WHO AREN'T IN WASHINGTON AND AREN'T AS TUNED IN TO THE SENATE PROCEEDINGS, IS THERE SOMETHING PARTICULARLY IMPORTANT COMING UP THAT WE SHOULD BE ATTUNED TO?

BOOKER: There's a lot of big issues that are on the Senate docket that you should be concerned with. The constant attempts to roll back health care, to attack Medicaid and Medicare, all of these things are really things we should stay focused on. I'm also a person who believes that we should stay focused on issues of justice wherever we are. Whether it's local issues about how the local jails are treating people or how issues of sexual harassment are now being addressed in our country, wherever you are, there are things that need attention, need activism. The road to progress is always under construction, and we have to say that we're going to be construction workers.

BESIDES THE WORK WE CAN DO NOW IN OUR LOCAL COMMUNITIES, WHAT WOULD YOUR ADVICE BE FOR THE POLITICALLY-INCLINED STUDENT?

BOOKER: I was a city councilperson—it was a local election. The guy who's holding this phone here, Matt Klapper [Booker's Chief of Staff], was just a high-school student and got involved with my efforts as a city councilperson. Getting involved. Rolling up your sleeves. You're going to learn so much by doing, more than by observing. So get involved in politics, whether it's at the local level or the state level or the national level. I just think that there's so much to learn from taking some time to volunteer for a candidate.

THERE ARE VARIOUS WAYS TO SERVE IN PUBLIC SERVICE, NOT ALL THAT REQUIRE RUNNING FOR OFFICE. WHAT WAS IT THAT CONVINCED YOU INITIALLY, IN THAT LOCAL RACE, TO DECIDE ON RUNNING?

BOOKER: A lot of the community leaders really pushed me to consider running for city council. It was a big struggle, a very difficult decision in my life, but I decided ultimately to run.

THE POLITIC RAPID-FIRE ROUND

WHERE DO YOU GET YOUR NEWS?

BOOKER: I subscribe online to The Washington Post, The New York Times, and The Wall Street Journal. I get a lot of news pushed at me from my social media feed, so I read articles that people tweet at me sometimes. I listen to a whole host of podcasts, from foreign policy podcasts to domestic policy podcasts to On Being and Tim Ferriss, so I get a lot of news through podcasts. I watch cable news, and CBS.

CHIEF OF STAFF MATT KLAPPER: and your staff briefs you sometimes.

BOOKER: *laughter* That actually is huge—I get a lot of news from my staff. Actually, let's put it this way: the plurality of the information I take is from what my staff tells me to read.

ARE YOU READING ANYTHING GOOD RIGHT NOW?

BOOKER: I actually just finished Evicted for my book club, which is Matthew Desmond's Pulitzer-prize winning book, which I would recommend.

Podcasts have really become so much a part of my life. I love Deray McKesson's Pod Save the People. I love that one, and On Being, it's really good spiritual podcast.

IF YOU WEREN'T DOING WHAT YOU'RE DOING NOW, WHAT WOULD YOU BE DOING?

BOOKER: I'd still be living where I'm living now. If I didn't have the job I have now, I'd still be doing what I'm doing now, which is trying to advocate for this country to live up to its promise to all Americans. So I would be doing what I'm doing now: living in the inner city, struggling to fight for issues that make a difference for people who are often marginalized in our country.

BUZZ-KILL

Connecticut's Honeybee Population in Peril

BY **THOMAS C. MARTIN**

EVERY BEEKEEPER FEARS a swarm, and Alison Moncrief Bromage is no different. One day late in the fall of 2015, Moncrief Bromage, a writing tutor at Ezra Stiles College, went to check on the honeybee hive that she and her neighbors managed in Branford, CT.

It was Moncrief Bromage's first year as an amateur apiarist, and she felt encouraged by her initial success: The hive seemed healthy, and she expected a fruitful honey yield. Honeybee activity can be roughly gauged by sound, so Moncrief Bromage pressed her ear against the outside of the hive and listened for buzzing.

She heard nothing. The hive was empty, save for the queen and a handful of worker bee attendants. Her bees had swarmed unexpectedly, either to start a new colony somewhere else or, less optimistically, to die. The loss hit the budding beekeeper hard.

"It felt like a miscarriage," she told *The Politic*.

The loss was devastating but not unique. Connecticut beekeepers lost 62 percent of their hives in 2016—significantly higher than the already alarmingly high national rate of 33 percent. Emma Mullen, a honeybee researcher with Cornell University's Pollinator Network, likened the situation to losing livestock.

"Imagine being a farmer that has cattle or some other livestock and having to deal with 62 percent of your cows dying every year," Mullen said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Not a lot of farmers would be in business still."

Beekeepers across the state are asking: What is killing Connecticut's bees, and what can be done to stop it?

Moncrief Bromage does not know why her first

hive swarmed. But the bees' disappearance—sudden and inexplicable—resembles a phenomenon that still haunts beekeepers more than a decade after it was first observed: colony collapse disorder.

Colony collapse disorder (CCD) was first observed in 2006. Mullen explained that no single cause for CCD has been determined. There are many possible culprits: parasites, pathogens, viruses, and harmful pesticides like neonicotinoids.

"It's probably a multitude of factors that are interacting with each other," she said.

The data behind bee mortality rates is imperfect and incomplete. Mullen acknowledged that some beekeepers are misdiagnosing their hives with CCD when other causes may be responsible.

"We don't have a great handle on how common it actually is," she said, adding that verification of CCD reports by experts is not common.

If CCD is not the cause of Connecticut's honeybee losses, the Varroa mite—a parasite that tucks itself into capped cells that are pregnant with bee larvae—could be. The adult mite lays several eggs. Its larvae then hatch and feed on the developing bees. The honeybee hosts emerge from their cells sickly and deformed, and the infestation spreads.

Mullen and her team conducted a statewide survey of New York beekeepers, and their research confirmed that Varroa mites are devastating bee populations. More than three quarters of the participating beekeepers had harmful levels of Varroa mite infestations in their hives. These same hives often had viral infections, which are nearly impossible to treat given the lack of antiviral bee medications.

Fellow beekeepers told Moncrief Bromage that a severe mite infestation in her first year was unlikely. She decided to soldier on, and began her second year with two hives and new bees shipped from Kentucky. She stressed the importance of preparing the bees for chilly winter months.

"By August, if things aren't going well, it's really not looking good going into the winter," she said. Both of her new hives failed after consistent trouble with their queens, leaving the beekeeper heartbroken once again.

This year was the first time that Moncrief Bromage treated her hive for Varroa mites. She felt more confident this time, since she was managing just one hive, and she had high expectations for honey and beeswax yields. She decided to go on a ten-year beekeeping hiatus if this year's bees swarmed again.

Moncrief Bromage's hopes were dashed when, early this October, she found her queen attended by just a few hundred bees. The rest of her hive was nowhere to be found.

"I didn't want to think there was symbolism here, that the bees kept leaving," she lamented, but her repeated losses have been discouraging.

Despite her dismay, Moncrief Bromage's passion for the art of beekeeping persists. "I love the lore and the mystery and magic of it," she said.

The practice has roots in ancient Egypt where honey was used to satiate both the elites and their gods. Honey played a key role not just on the table, but in the tomb, as it was a crucial ingredient during the embalming process. Egyptians used beeswax, which was cheap and widely available, to seal jars, make medicines, and wax wigs. Like honey, it played a role in the funerary customs of the ancient Egyptians. Embalmers plugged bodily orifices with beeswax before burial.



PHOTO BY **EMMA MULLEN**



PHOTO BY **ALISON MONCRIEF BROMAGE**

Moncrief Bromage, a published poet, discovered beekeeping through Sylvia Plath's poetry. Plath's father was a highly regarded apiarist in his time, and Plath decided to try her hand at the craft. Her poetry catalogs her experiences handling the bees, from dumping her first hive to collecting honey before winter. It is no wonder that the rich descriptions inspired a fellow poet to take up the art.

But inspiration will not save the honeybees. Moncrief Bromage, still searching for ways to keep her bees alive, is at a loss. Mullen's research could provide Moncrief Bromage and other struggling beekeepers with some much-needed answers.

A surprising discovery in Mullen's survey concerned the use of pesticides. Neonicotinoids, a class of pesticides, kill insects by incapacitating their central nervous systems. The chemicals have a bad reputation among beekeepers and environmental activists, and for good reason: research has shown that neonicotinoid exposure harms bee reproduction and health. In 2018, Maryland will become the first state to issue a neonicotinoid ban, a move motivated in large part by the state's dwindling number of honeybees. Compared to Maryland's losses, Connecticut's were even more severe.

Mullen has found that certain pesticides can have ruinous effects on the health of bees, but her research gives beekeepers reason to be optimistic. Very few hives surveyed in the study harbored harmful levels of pesticides, which means the chemicals are not likely to be the primary cause of Connecticut's bee crisis.

Though pesticides may not pose an acute risk to honeybees, Mullen acknowledges that low-dose exposure could still have long-term effects.

But another factor lurks behind New England's honeybee losses. The problem may not be parasites or pesticides but the bees themselves. When Moncrief Bromage's first hive swarmed, she replaced those bees with new ones shipped from Kentucky, a state with a much warmer climate than Connecticut's. The practice of importing honeybees from warmer climates is not unique to amateur beekeepers like Moncrief Bromage.

Ian Knisely founded East Rock Apiary in New Haven, CT, with his father in 2013. Knisely was reading articles about CCD when he remembered that his father used to tend bees as a child. Eager to help combat the spread of CCD, Knisely convinced his father to revisit beekeeping, and East Rock Apiary was born.

The Kniselys sell honey and beeswax products at local farmers' markets and on their website. But profit was not the point. The mission was what mattered to Knisely.

"It's a win-win, not only because we give back and contribute, but we also get honey, which is a bonus," he said.

The apiary has been generally successful at keeping its bee population healthy. But last winter, the apiary lost several hives to unknown causes. Knisely suspects CCD was the culprit.

To recover from the loss, Knisely and his father raised a few of their own queens, a process that involves feeding bee larvae a strict diet of royal jelly, a substance

that causes larvae to develop into fertile queens if consumed in large quantities. The Kniselys then divided existing hives into smaller clusters and introduced the new queens. The smaller hives grew independently of one another and eventually matured into fully functional colonies.

Like Moncrief Bromage, Knisely also ordered honeybees from other states—Georgia, in particular—to replace some of the lost bees. Knisely thinks the imported bees were a boon to his hives, adding that their distinct genetics allowed him "to mix and match a little bit."

But bee importation comes with several disadvantages.

Shipped bees almost always come from climates warmer than New England's, typically the South and California, where winters are not as harsh. Those bees may die off simply because they are not accustomed to the colder conditions. Richard Cowles, an agricultural researcher for the state of Connecticut, told the *Hartford Courant* last May that the bees from warmer climates can weaken the honeybee gene pool in New England and spawn populations that are ill-prepared for winter and less likely to survive.

In addition, mail-order bees travel in close quarters for long stretches of time during shipping. Stress from the journey makes the bees more susceptible to disease and parasites, and their close proximity to one another contributes to the spread of pathogens. When the transporter distributes the bees to different hives across the region, the infestations can spread exponentially.

One prime suspect remains: climate change, the least tangible yet most troubling explanation for Con-

"I love the lore and the mystery and magic of it."



PHOTO BY ALISON MONCRIEF BROMAGE



PHOTO BY **EMMA MULLEN**

necticut's honeybee decline. Unlike parasites and pesticides, climate change is impossible for beekeepers to combat directly. There is no quick fix.

The honeybee crisis has been brewing for years. A U.S. Department of Agriculture study conducted with preserved goldenrod specimens dating as far back as 1842 found that as atmospheric carbon dioxide levels rose, the amount of protein found in goldenrod pollen decreased significantly.

"Pollen is becoming junk food for bees," Lewis Ziska, a botanical researcher, told *Yale Environment 360* last year. Bees, both managed and unmanaged, rely almost exclusively on pollen for protein. While the drop in protein caused by climate change might not have an obvious impact on honeybee mortality, poor nutrition can make bees more susceptible to disease.

Without antiviral medications for bees, there is only so much that beekeepers can do to protect their hives from the pathogens to which they are now more susceptible. Beekeepers like Moncrief Bromage who have struggled repeatedly with parasites, viruses, and other diseases are understandably frustrated.

"You've caught me at this kind of crossroads," Moncrief Bromage said. "The mystery and the lore have got a hold of me."

The mystery is poetic, but it also has the potential to be catastrophic. Modern agriculture cannot function without honeybees. Of the 100 crops that feed the majority of the world's population, 70 are pollinated by bees. They provide a 30 billion dollar service each year for free, not including revenue from honey and beeswax. It would be nearly impossible to feed the world's livestock without the bees' charitable contributions to the food chain.

The need for beekeepers has never been greater. Whether Moncrief Bromage adheres to her ten-year hiatus is yet to be seen. Despite her previous failures, beekeeping still enchants her.

"When you dump your first hive," she beamed, "I think that's the other side of beekeeping."

When Moncrief Bromage began her first year, she shook out the shipping box of honeybees over her empty hive. She watched in awe as the bees fell from their wooden container into their new home. The writhing, sibilating, viscous mass of wings, antennae, and thoraxes went straight to work.

"You can't read about that," she said, laughing warmly.



"BORDERLANDERS": THE EMERALD ISLE BRACES FOR BREXIT

BY KEVIN SWAIN





TODAY, "BORDERLANDERS" can drive along more than 200 weaving roads that cross and recross the border between the Republic of Ireland and Northern Ireland. The border stretches 310 miles between the sea inlet Carlingford Lough in the east and Lough Foyle, an estuary, in the northwest. It divides rivers, fields, and bridges. Up to 35,000 people cross the border each day.

But it has not always been this way. Before a landmark peace deal in 1998, conflict left the border militarized, with checkpoints, watchtowers, and roadblocks restricting travel. For many, dealing with the border was not just a nuisance—it was a way of life. But after the 1998 Good Friday agreement, the border became virtually nonexistent, and both sides have lived in relative peace ever since.

Now, Britain's decision to leave the European Union (EU) threatens to disrupt the peace and bring back a "hard border" with checkpoints. Although it represents less than three percent of the United Kingdom's population, Northern Ireland, along with the Republic of Ireland to its south, has the potential to be the region most affected by Brexit.

Post-Brexit trade and migration restrictions could complicate the movement of goods and people between Northern Ireland (part of the UK) and the Republic of Ireland (part of the EU). During the 2016 EU referendum, most Northern Irish did not vote to leave the EU: 55.8 percent voted to "Remain." But when the UK exits the EU, England and Wales (both of which voted to Leave) will drag Northern Ireland and Scotland (both of which voted to Remain) out with it.

The island of Ireland has been divided into two countries for nearly 100 years. Unlike Southern Ireland, which in 1922 became the Irish Free State (now the Republic of Ireland), Northern Ireland continued to be part of the UK.

Northern Ireland's history is marked by tensions between the unionist Protestant majority and a nationalist Catholic minority. Many residents are Protestant descendants of colonists from Great Britain. Hostilities culminated in "the Troubles," a period between the late 1960s and 1998 of violent clashes between paramilitary groups. The conflict claimed an estimated 3,500 lives and resulted in tens of thousands of injuries.

"[The border] was militarized," said Jane Morrice, former Head of the European Commission Office in Northern Ireland, in an interview with *The Politic*. "There were checkpoints checking people and cars…It was a mini-Berlin Wall if you like. It was the militarization which was the most difficult part."

> "It was a mini-Berlin Wall if you like."

After decades of sporadic conflict, the 1998 Good Friday Agreement between the British and Irish governments and Northern Ireland's political parties set out new terms for relationships between the three sides. Central to the agreement were proposals to create a Northern Ireland Assembly, to decommission weapons, to reform policing in Northern Ireland, and to release paramilitary prisoners. Today, with both countries at peace and in the EU's single market, the border is porous—at least for now.

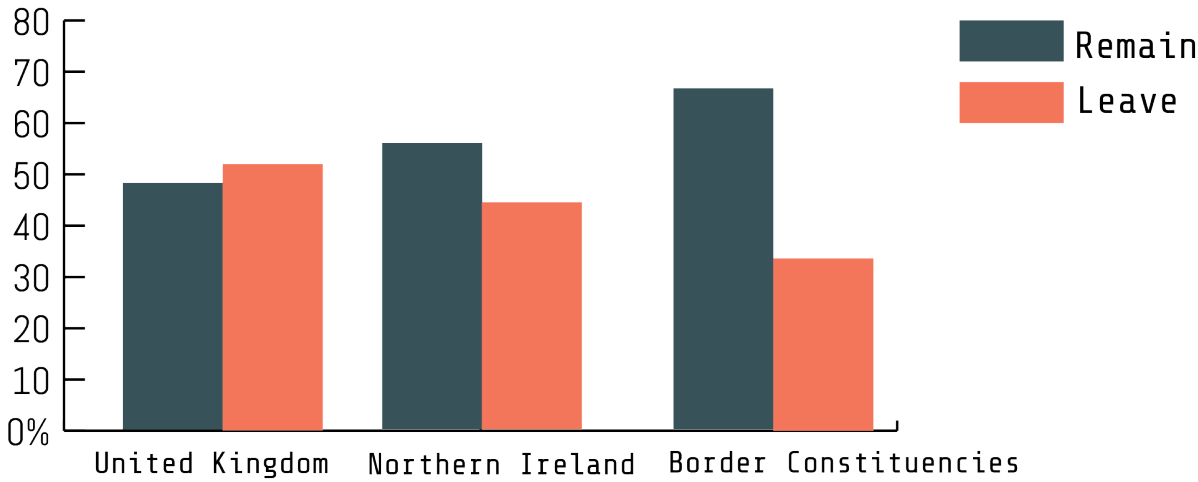
"The day before the UK voted to leave the EU, there were reasons to be optimistic about the border," cartographer and Queen's University Belfast Professor Garrett Carr told *The Politic*. "After a lot of uncertainty and violence, the border was finally starting to work."

In Northern Ireland, a majority of voters opted to remain in the EU. Voters living along the border preferred continued EU membership by even larger margins than their neighbors elsewhere in the country. For these "Borderlanders," as Carr refers to those living in border areas, the Brexit vote was a brusque reminder that many in the rest of the UK consider geographically isolated Northern Ireland to be politically insignificant.

Now, with ongoing negotiations about borders between the EU and the UK, people on the island are not sure whether they will be able to cross into the neighboring country without checkpoints—a reminder of an era that few are eager to resurrect.

"[After the Good Friday Agreement,] the border was then plain countryside, indistinguishable from any other stretch of farmland and hills in Ireland. We were free to look at the border as a living thing where things happened, rather than a site of restriction or challenge," said Carr. "It could just be ignored. There were no checkpoints or customs there to challenge your identity as you drove home. This is a great arrangement to have arrived at. As Brexit rolls out, we must attempt to preserve it."

Another uncertainty is whether



Great Britain will leave the EU's single market and customs union. The customs union makes the EU a unified trading area where goods can circulate freely without duties or border checks. The single market additionally permits free movement of people and services—most prominently, by eliminating immigration controls.

An exit from either the customs union or the single market could cause the UK to turn to non-EU countries for a greater share of its imports, a choice that would have implications for the remaining 27 EU member states. Dan O'Brien of The Institute of International and European Affairs, told *The Politic* that the Republic of Ireland could be influenced even more significantly. He said if Brexit has a negative impact on the British economy, it will likely have an equally negative, if not greater, effect on Ireland's economy. At present, two-way trade between the UK and the Republic is worth 60 billion euros annually.

In particular, a customs union exit could upset UK-Republic agricultural supply chains. Milk, for example, can seamlessly cross the border multiple times (for use in pasteurization and cheese processing, for instance) before it is a finished product. If Britain exits the single market and customs union, the integrated supply chain for dairy products would be subject to customs controls, tariffs, and excise taxes.

At present, agricultural products from non-EU countries face heavy regulation. As a result, Ireland and other EU members play a large role in feeding Great Britain's 65 million people. If Britain were to leave the single market and customs union, Irish farmers stand to lose a significant competitive advantage.

"The worst case scenario," O'Brien said, "is that effectively, agriculture in the Republic is profoundly transformed because it loses its biggest market, which is Britain."

The "best-case scenario" for many Irish farmers would be for Britain to remain in both the EU single market and the customs union. It is unlikely that both will happen. To stay in the single market would require free movement of people, forcing Britain to abandon the idea of immigration controls central to the "Leave" platform. And if Britain were to remain in the customs union, it would be unable to make new bilateral trade deals on agricultural products with third-party countries: another disappointment for free-market Brexiteers.

"The hope is that Britain would see that the cost of leaving the customs union would be greater than the benefits of free trade deals with third countries, and that they end up staying in the customs union," O'Brien said. "That's the most that can be realistically expected, certainly from an Irish perspective."

European Union policy also requires free movement of qualified



United Kingdom (in blue)



Northern Ireland
(Border Constituencies in blue)

professionals who may cross internal EU borders to practice their occupation. John Woods, the Northern Ireland council chair for the British Medical Association, noted on the BBC in June that Northern Ireland relies on the Republic for certain specialist services, the quality of which may decline if Irish doctors, for example, face new border restrictions. Other cross-border health services, such as the cancer center in Londonderry, Northern Ireland that serves numerous Irish patients, could also find themselves in jeopardy.

Much of the current apprehension on the island, according to Yale political science professor Bonnie Weir, lies with the older population—people who remember the pre-1998 Troubles and who are opposed to any sort of reimplementation of a hard border.

"[There are] thousands of people who live on one side of the border and work on the other, and their ability to get to their place of work or to their families would be severely restricted," Weir, who has extensively studied Northern Ireland's post-conflict transformation, told *The Politic* in an interview.

"That is a practical effect that would be very detrimental to the lives of so many people. But then you also have psychological effects—the number of people that still remember the heavily militarized border and the sense of a lack of control over one's own life and where one travels—that would come flooding back immediately," she continued.

The UK government understands this, and the future of the border has taken a prominent position in Brexit negotiations. More than a year after the Brexit vote, "Borderlanders" have few answers about their future. The Irish question is a priority in the UK's negotiations with the EU, but so far there has been no agreement about what the border will look like post-Brexit. In late October, British Prime Minister Theresa May

triumphantly assured the House of Commons that there will be no checkpoint infrastructure—in other words, no hard border of the sort that older Irish citizens remember from before 1998. It remains unclear, however, how a soft border would be possible if the UK were to exit the customs union, since the EU currently has border controls with all countries outside the customs union or single market. Many members of the British government have said the UK plans to leave both.

The UK and the EU will therefore likely have to come to a special agreement on the Ireland question. One proposal, put forth by Morrice, would give Northern Ireland honorary EU association, allowing it to remain in both the UK and the EU. She told *The Politic* that she had plans to present her proposal at the European Commission office in Dublin.

"We were free to look at the border as a living thing where things happened, rather than a site of restriction or challenge"

Across the island, local governments have mobilized in response to Brexit. In a statement released to *The Politic*, the Belfast City Council said that a special committee meeting has been scheduled for November to "have an informed discussion on the issue of Brexit to understand the potential impacts and to consider Belfast's resilience to meet the challenges and take advantage of the opportunities for the future."

Despite the challenges posed by Brexit, "Borderlanders" are sure to do everything in their power to avoid a return to their painful history.

"We have been turning around to face each other and getting to know each other," Morrice said of the people working together to heal Northern Ireland's wounds, "and we don't want to turn our backs on each other."

"Our Country,

Alternative for Germany challenges the politics of national guilt

BY **FAITH VASQUEZ**

A POSTER FOR Alternative for Germany (AfD) held by a marcher in the street reads *"Unsere Land, Unsere Heimat."* "Our Country, Our Home."

Significant throughout German history, *heimat* describes a person's relationship to his or her homeland and local community. Before World War II, *heimat* carried different meanings in different provinces and towns. Cities had *heimat* museums that displayed the notion of home for that specific place.

During the rise of National Socialism, *heimat* shifted from having a local emphasis to defining citizens' national identity. The Nazis used *heimat* as a symbol of their ideal German to create the concept of the "other."

Germany's populist party, *Alternative für Deutschland*, has used *heimat* in their appeals to voters. This year, the party received 12.6 percent of the votes in the September 24 election. Now that it has passed the five percent threshold needed to secure a place in government, the AfD is the third-largest party in the German parliament. The AfD's use of *heimat* carries a strong resemblance to the nationalist tone of pre-WWII politics in Germany.

Our Home"

The Nazis used *Heimat* as a symbol of their ideal German to create the concept of the "other."

Since the election, the German people have grappled with how to confront the results, which have left the other 87 percent of voters alarmed.

But who comprises AfD's 13 percent vote share?

The AfD runs on a platform that is strongly nationalist, anti-immigration, and anti-Islamic. Initially, the party gained momentum through opposition to German Chancellor Angela Merkel's response to the Eurozone crisis. Since then, much of its xenophobic rhetoric has revolved around the global refugee crisis.

"I think it's really a response to a sort of disillusionment with German political options," Yale history professor Jennifer Allen said of the AfD in an interview with *The Politic*.

AfD supporters are not a homogenous group. While many have long supported the party's far-right politics, 1.2 million previous non-voters also backed the AfD this election. What's more, the party won the support of some leftist voters.

Many of the AfD's supporters were protest voters, who expressed their dissatisfaction with the current government and a lack of political options. Polls from German television reveal that approximately 60 percent of AfD voters "voted 'against all other parties.'"

"This has been a common phenomenon over the course of the postwar period," Allen said. "The other part of the constellation is a frustration with Merkel's handling with both the Euro crisis and the refugee crisis."

Although exit polls and interviews show that protest votes and hesitant support contributed to AfD's strong showing, far-right ideology also motivated some voters.

"There have always been hard right movements and far-left movements that are highly ideological," Constanze Stelzenmüller, a political scientist and expert in German and European policy, explained in an interview with *The Politic*. "Other voters had defected from other parties, mainly the CDU [Christian Democratic Union]."

"It has nothing to do with economics," Stelzenmüller said. "What people are more worried about specifically is the refugee crisis [and] a loss of control."

The refugee crisis has had a significant impact in Germany. According to the *BBC*, Germany received 476,000 applications for asylum in 2015, and according to *Politico*, the crisis cost Germany 20 billion euros in 2016.

While the strong anti-immigration sentiment and nationalism coincide with a general rise in populism in the Western world, the AfD has used a narrative of

"I'm afraid that as the discourse in society moves further to the right, that racist and xenophobic positions could become more socially acceptable and more popular."

national pride to directly question Germany's relationship with its history. German identity is heavily intertwined with the memory of the Holocaust, and the AfD argues that this historical guilt is harmful.

"The AfD has spoke[n] pretty openly about their opposition to making shame a sort of literal and metaphorical core of Germanness," Allen said.

The party's desire to reclaim nationalism after decades of post-war guilt has left other Germans uncomfortable about national pride. As a German citizen told *Deutsche Welle*, "I'm afraid that as the discourse in society moves further to the right, that racist and xenophobic positions could become more socially acceptable and more popular."

Most party members acknowledge the existence of the Holocaust but advocate for a reduction in the German emphasis on shame. Some party leaders go farther, however, and minimize the harms done during the Holocaust.

In addition to ongoing dialogue about national consciousness, the monuments and memorials dotting the landscape have ensured a constant reflection and remembrance of victims and their suffering.

For example, artist Gunter Demnig began his notable monument *Stolperstein*, or Stumbling Stones, in 1992. The small concrete stones he made bear the name, birthday, and date of death of individual Nazi victims. Each stone is laid in front of the last home the victim lived in before they were killed. Approximately 60,000 stones spread across 1,200 cities were laid by the end of last year.

With Holocaust education, emotional remembrance, and physical reminders, German guilt plays a central part in how citizens view themselves and their history.

"The consciousness of national disgrace is inescapable for every German," argued political philosopher Karl Jaspers in his book *The Question of German Guilt*. While Jasper's claim was made shortly following the war, this collective phenomenon has transcended the passage of time.

"[The AfD] already [has] a strong impact on the debate of what it means to be German," Julian Göppfarth, a PhD candidate at the European Institute, told *The Politic*. "It's a very ethnic understanding of German nationhood."

The AfD's rhetoric about Germany's self image sparks the question of how to reconcile nationalism with a history of shame. AfD's answer is to embrace aggressive nationalism and return to a "Germany first" ideology.

Unsere Land,

Göppfarth describes this movement as an effort to "give a new meaning to the name of Heimat."

The party advocates for a strong German identity, and employs divisive tactics to achieve its goals. AfD, like many far-right populist parties, uses national pride as a means of "othering" various different groups. This surge in xenophobia is in response to an influx of refugees and immigrants.

The AfD's reclaiming of *heimat*, then, hinges on prioritizing Germanness and German pride through the simultaneous creation and suppression of the "other." This interpretation is noteworthy in its departure from the original meaning of Heimat, which described an individual's attachment to their local culture and identity.

In today's integrated Europe, a closed-off and bordered "Germanness" is increasingly harder to locate and grasp.

"There's a sense that Germany is getting lost either to Europe or to something global, that an investment in the national is sort of withering away," Allen said.

The question remains whether AfD's ascension to power is symbolic of an increase in radical right-wing thought in Germany. Now that the parliament is in session, coalition building will determine the extent of AfD's impact.

"They say what has to happen in Germany is that we have to move away from this focus on this negative aspect of German history," Göppfarth said of AfD's arguments regarding Holocaust memory.

Today, as World War II becomes increasingly distant, Germans must grapple with their national identity. With new influence in the Bundestag, the AfD has the opportunity to make its case.

The AfD's reclaiming of *heimat*, then, hinges on prioritizing Germanness and German pride through the simultaneous creation and suppression of the "other."

Unsere Heimat.

on-line pre-view

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Land of a Rising Military? Japan Considers Dropping Its Official Commitment to Peace

BY **JOSH PURTELL '21**

Japan has not had a formal military in seven decades, but emerging threats—including a nuclear North Korea—might be about to change that. Josh Purtell '21 explains how Prime Minister Shinzō Abe's plans to abandon pacifism are becoming a reality.

Constitutionality, Complicated by Reality: The Cost of the Bail Bond System

BY **BERENICE VALENCIA FERNANDEZ**

Berenice Valencia Fernandez explores how bail bonds, for-profit bail businesses, and the criminal justice system impact families.

Should Jeremy Corbyn's Ideas Cross the Atlantic?

BY **KATE KUSHNER '21**

The Labour Party defied predictions with its unexpected success in Britain's June election, and some American liberals are looking to Corbyn for inspiration. But Labour's path to success may not be the blueprint Democrats are looking for.

Pardoned: The Formerly-Incarcerated Seek A Second Chance

BY **MOLLY SHAPIRO '21**

The pardon application process is time consuming, expensive, and a barrier to societal reentry for the formerly incarcerated. Project Fresh Start helps returning citizens with these applications, in addition to providing job and housing assistance. Molly Shapiro '21 investigates the pardon process and hears from Project Fresh Start's employees about why they are dedicated to the program's mission.

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Yale University
Judaic Studies Program
presents

ISAAC BOUND AND UNBOUND: THE AKEDA IN THE WORK OF S.Y. AGNON AND YEHUDA AMICHAI

Presented by

SIDRA DEKOVEN EZRAHI

Genesis 22, the story of the binding of Isaac (referred to in Hebrew shorthand as the akeda) is one of the most familiar of all biblical stories and a foundation of both Jewish and Christian theodicy. It is at the center of exegetical and poetic retellings over the centuries and has particular relevance in Jerusalem after 1967.

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Sidra DeKoven Ezrahi is *Professor Emerita of Comparative Jewish Literature at the Hebrew University of Jerusalem and was visiting professor at Duke, Princeton, Yale, Michigan and Dartmouth. She is the author of By Words Alone: The Holocaust in Literature (1980), which was a finalist for the National Jewish Book Award and Booking Passage: Exile and Homecoming in the Modern Jewish Imagination (2000), which was a finalist for the Koret Jewish Book Award. Her work ranges from explorations of literary and cultural representations of the Holocaust to studies of the Jewish configurations of exile and homecoming. Ezrahi was a featured speaker at the Chicago Humanities Festival (November, 2005) and the Jewish Arts Festival in New York (September, 2006). In 2007 she was awarded a Guggenheim fellowship for her project on "Jerusalem and the Poetics of Return." This talk is part of that project.*



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